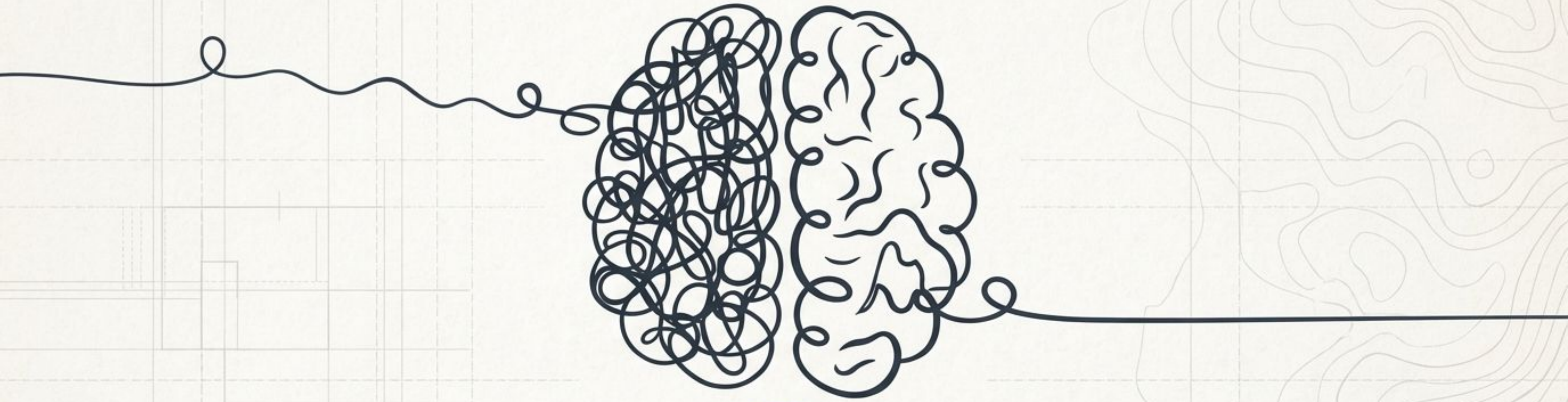
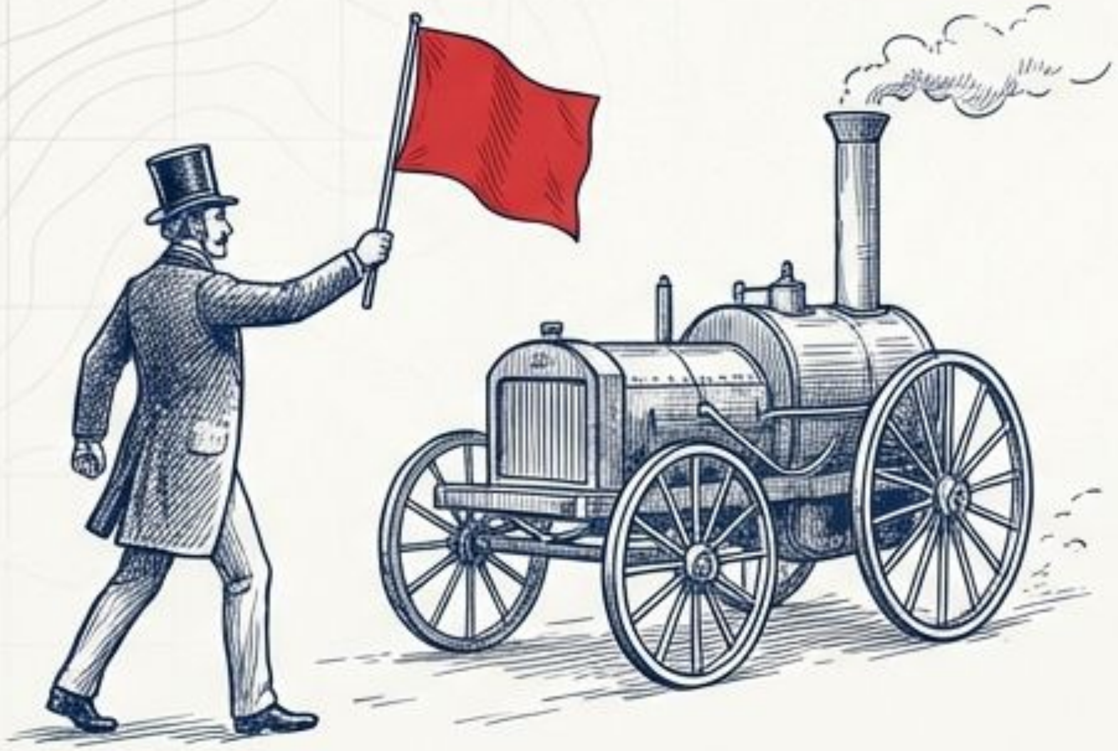


Designing for AGENCY

Human-Centered Transformation in the Era of AI

Dion Norman & Nick Garvin | Chadwick International

A Question of Default Settings



The Tendency for Prohibition.

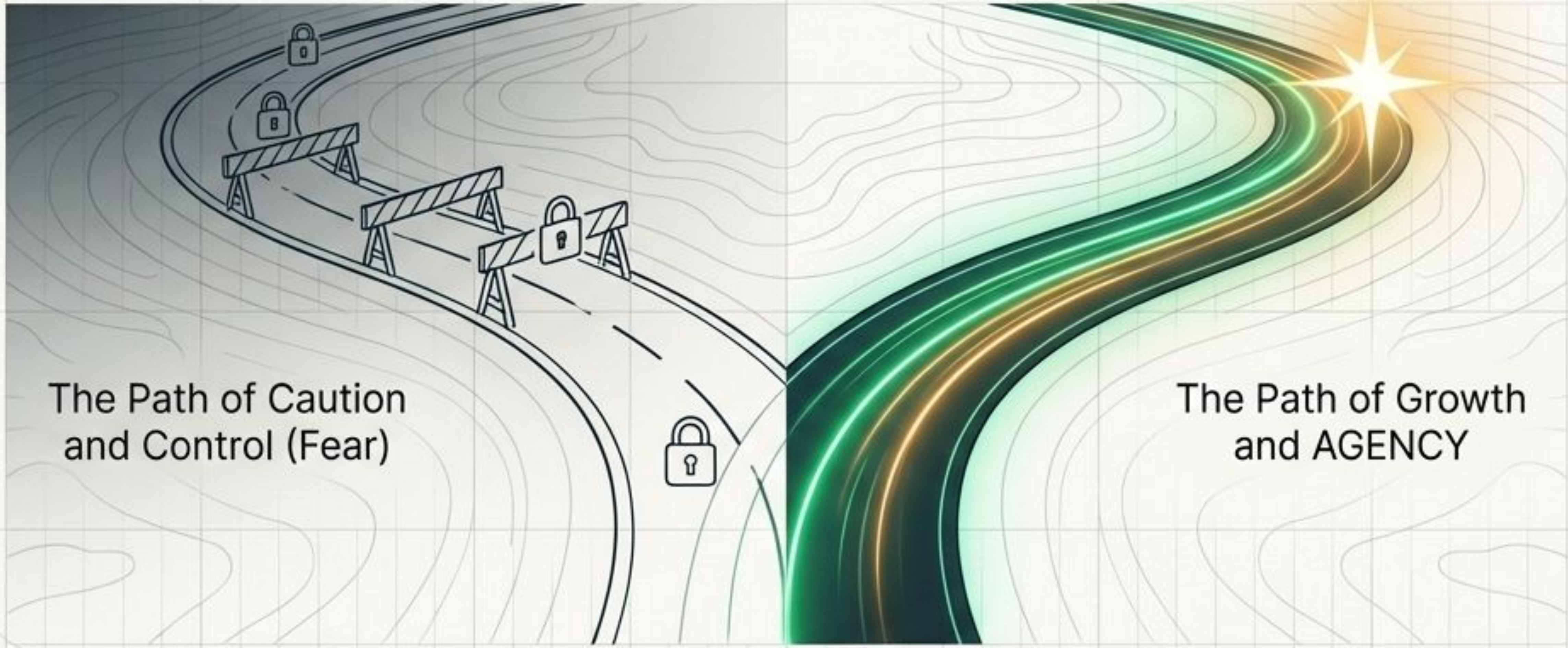
When disruptive change arrives, does your institution default to the ‘Red Flag Act’—attempting to slow down the future to protect the present?

The Tendency for Experimentation.

Or do you adopt the Pioneer Mindset—stepping into the unknown to map the new terrain?

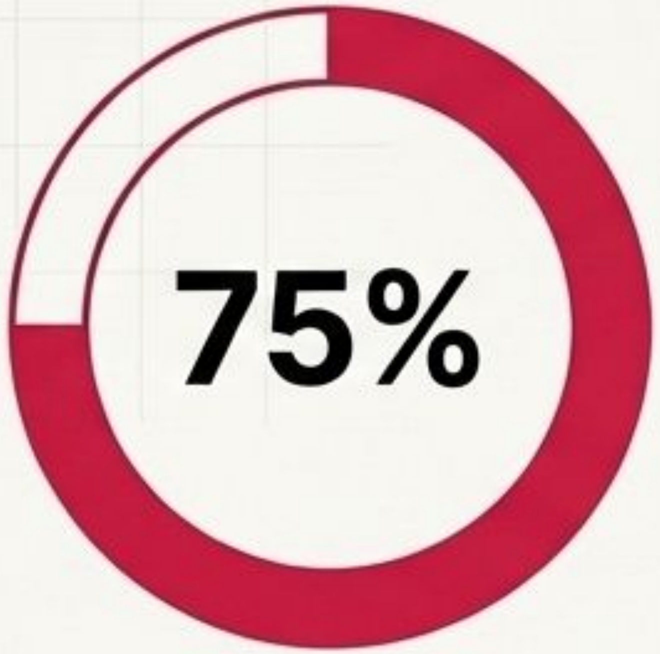
The reaction to a new technology is never just about the tool itself. It is a referendum on a school’s core philosophy.

A Philosophical Fork in the Road



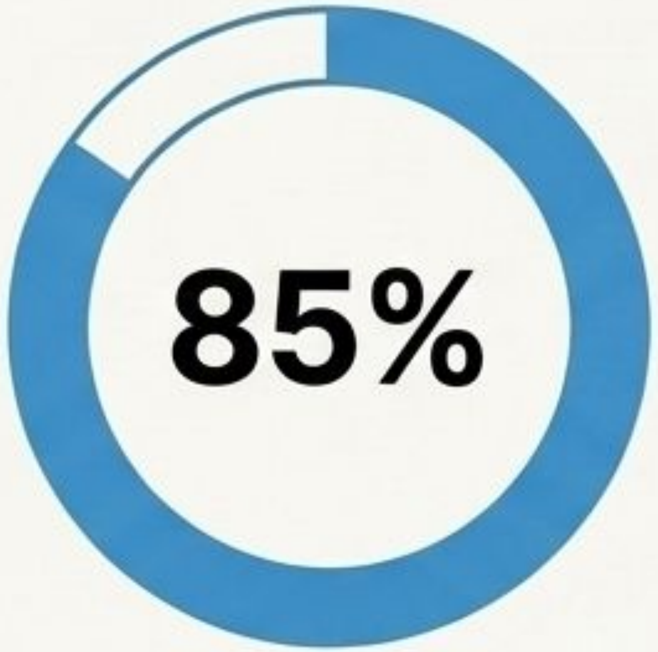
Remember the Red Flag Act and the Kodak Warning. When we mistake the product (the photograph, the written essay) for the purpose (the memory, the cognitive process), we build policies designed to preserve the past rather than prepare for the future.

The True Cost of the Fence



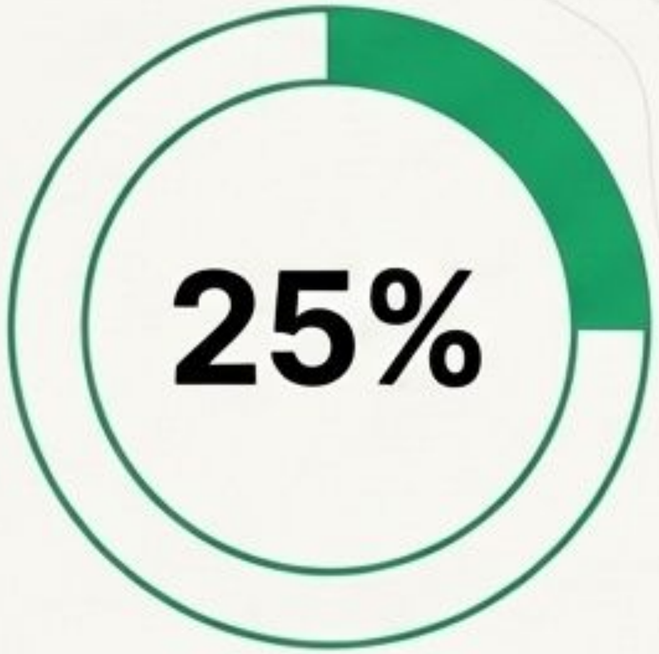
Higher Costs

Training and equipment expenses increase defending unpoliceable tech.



Higher Technostress

Educator anxiety, burnout, and resistance grow.

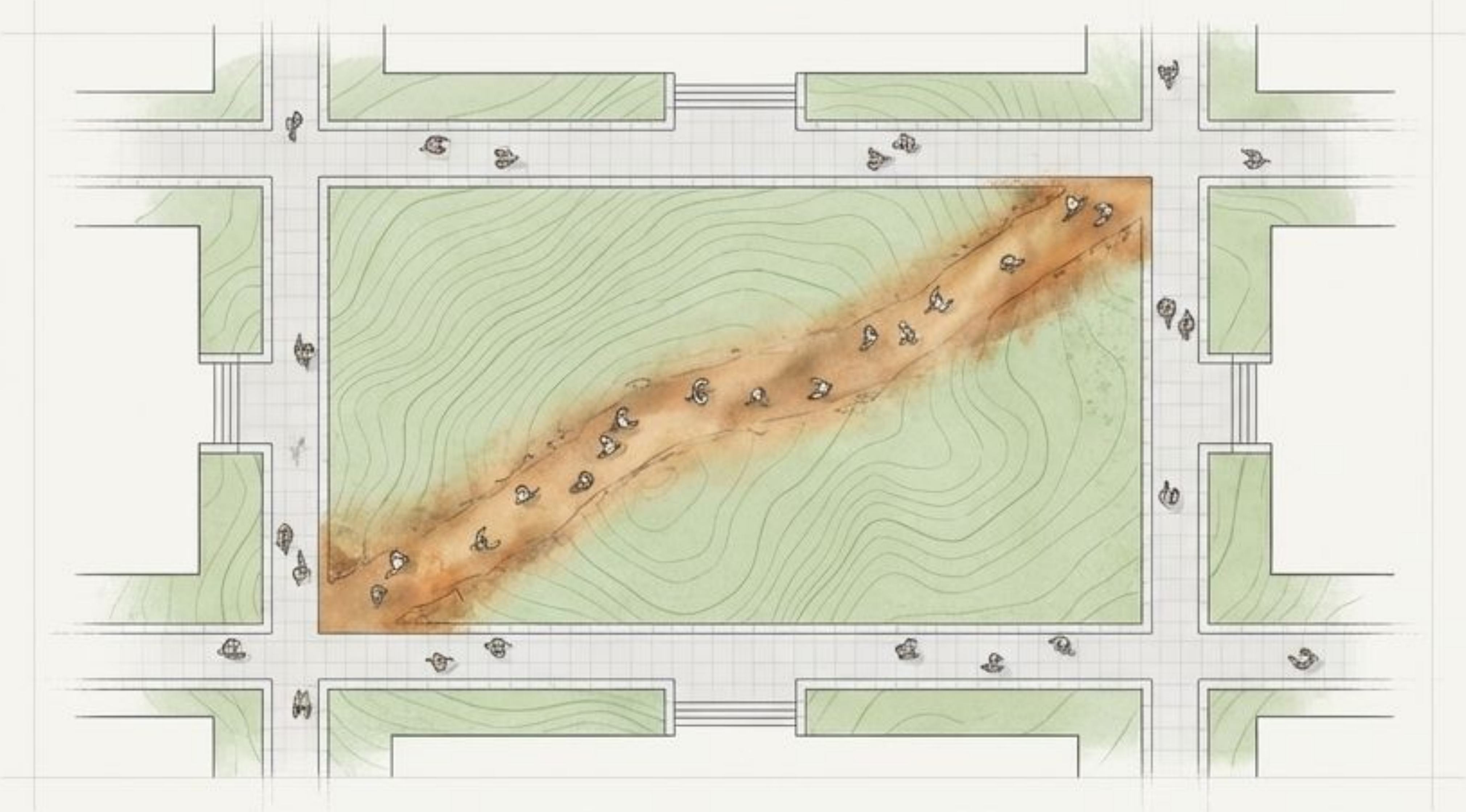


Lower Level of Use

Classroom implementation remains minimal; students use shadow IT.

Instructionism and the Banking Model of education see AI as a threat to the deposit of knowledge. The instinct is to build a fence, but the retreat into surveillance is a managed decline into irrelevance.

The Desire Path: A Fundamental Choice



AI is the greatest Desire Path in the history of education.

Students have found a tool that gets them to the destination faster than the rigid grid we designed. We can choose to be offended, put up Keep Off the Grass signs, and build fences. Or, we can realize they have found a more efficient way—and pave the path.

Mapping the Terrain: The East Asian AI Landscape

South Korea (The AI Basic Act)

Legal Stance: Binding Regulation (Effective 2026).

Primary Goal: Trust, safety, and strict governance.

Impact: Schools classified as 'High-Impact Zones' requiring mandatory human oversight and legal 'Right to Explanation.'

Japan (The AI Promotion Act)

Legal Stance: Non-binding / 'Soft Law' framework.

Primary Goal: Innovation-First. To become the world's most "AI-friendly" country.

Impact: Relies on voluntary cooperation, encouraging R&D, and signaling administrative freedom rather than punitive enforcement.

Japan's legal framework **removes the friction of rigid compliance, giving you the ultimate freedom to proactively design for Agency.**

The Legal Landscape: A Tale of Two Acts

South Korea (AI Basic Act – Jan 2026)

- Stance: Binding Regulation (Schools classified as High-Impact AI zones).
- Focus: Trust, Governance, and strict Human-in-the-Loop oversight.
- Mandate: Students have a legal Right to Explanation for any AI-assisted grading.

Japan (AI Promotion Act – May 2024)

- Stance: Non-Binding / Soft Law.
- Focus: Innovation-First approach to become the world's most AI-friendly country.
- Mandate: Promotes voluntary business compliance, industrial use, and agile governance over rigid penalties.

Synthesizing the Law: The Human-First Protocol

We do not need to choose between compliance and innovation. By demanding mandatory human-to-human collaboration and human review of all AI outputs, we simultaneously satisfy the strict Human-in-the-Loop legal requirements of Korea while leveraging the rapid innovation encouraged by Japan.

Calibrating Our Compass

Relationships Drive the Mission.

The primary risks of AI—passive acceptance, the hollowing out of authenticity, and human disconnection—directly contradict our core values.

Our greatest mitigation strategy isn't a software tool or a plagiarism checker; it is our institutional philosophy.

Process Over Product

The Vending Machine

Transactional AI.
The Empty Essay where students decouple achievement from cognitive growth. Mistaking the output for learning.

The Studio

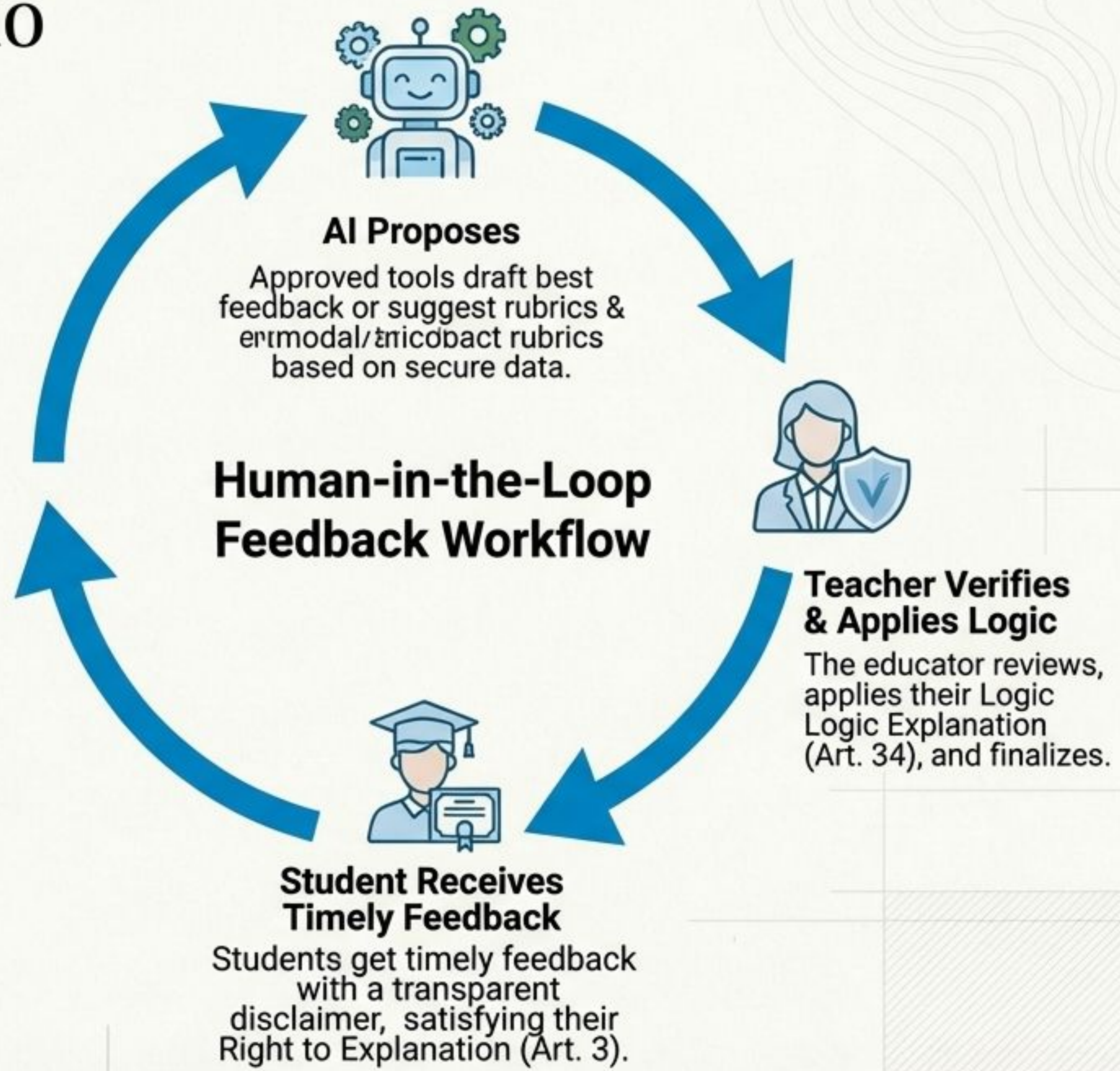
The Apprentice Model.
Assessing the process of learning, ensuring the assessment remains an inherently human endeavor.

The Promise of the Studio

AI allows us to change the nature of interaction from a passive transaction to an active, collaborative dialogue.

It is the steering wheel that forces the student to articulate intent, define ethical bound boundaries, and document critical thinking.

We use the machine to make the human cognitive process visible.



The Human-First Protocol: Compliance as Pedagogy

Step 1: The Mandate

AI cannot be the sole decider of an outcome. Humans must remain in the loop.

Step 2: The Pedagogical Reality

Good teaching has always been Human-in-the-Loop. Unchecked AI grading isn't just a legal risk; it's a pedagogical failure.

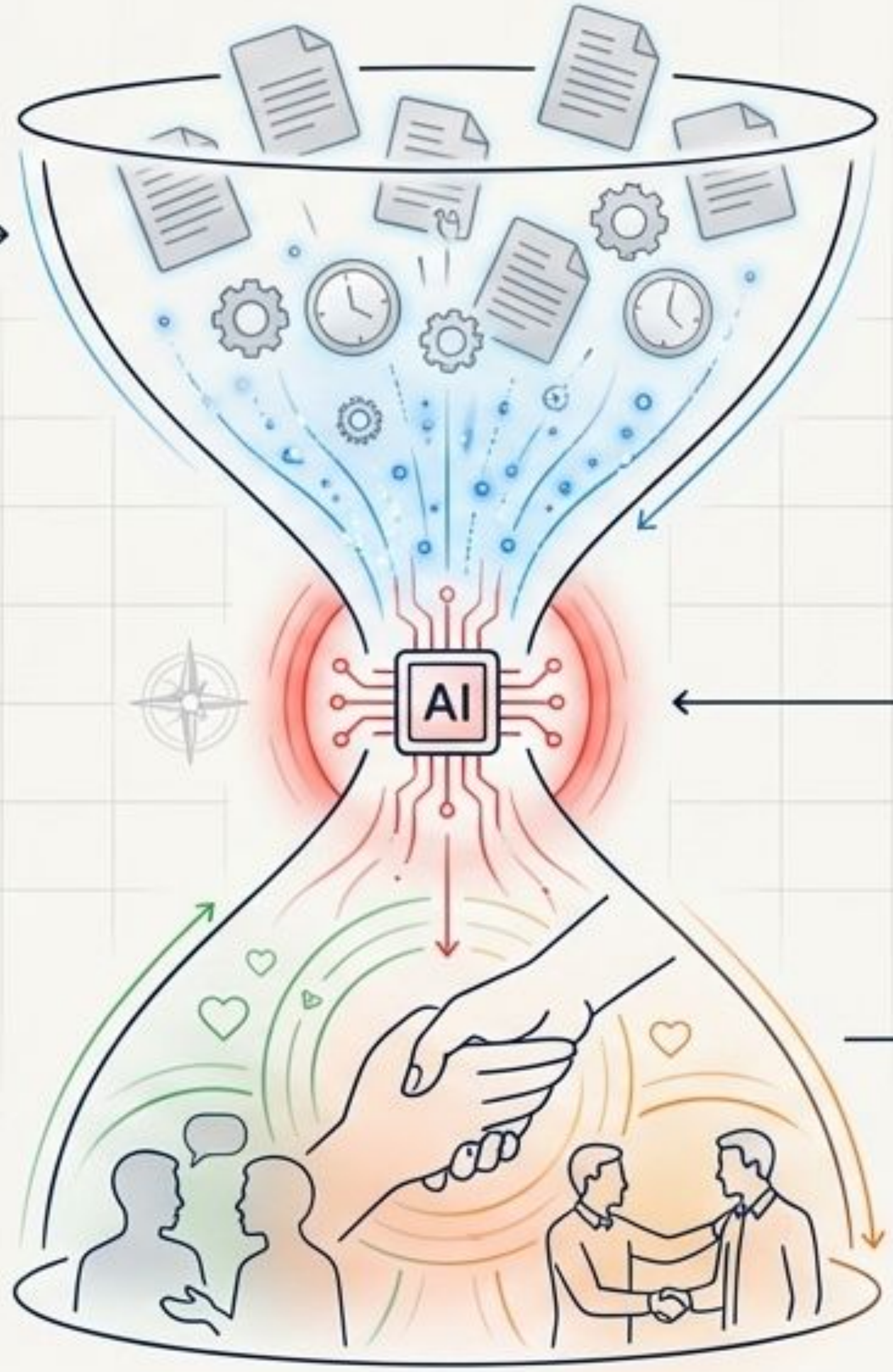
Step 3: Process Over Product

By ensuring human-to-human collaboration and requiring teachers to apply professional judgment to AI outputs, we naturally mitigate risk while elevating authentic assessment.

Reinvesting the AI Dividend

The Efficiency Engine

AI takes on the administrative grind, automating repetitive tasks, drafting rubrics, and synthesizing data.



The Dividend

The time saved by this efficiency is our "AI Dividend." It is not meant to simply make us work faster.

The Reinvestment

We deliberately reinvest this saved time back into the "Human Core"—deepening one-on-one connections, mentoring, and fostering the relationships that drive our mission.

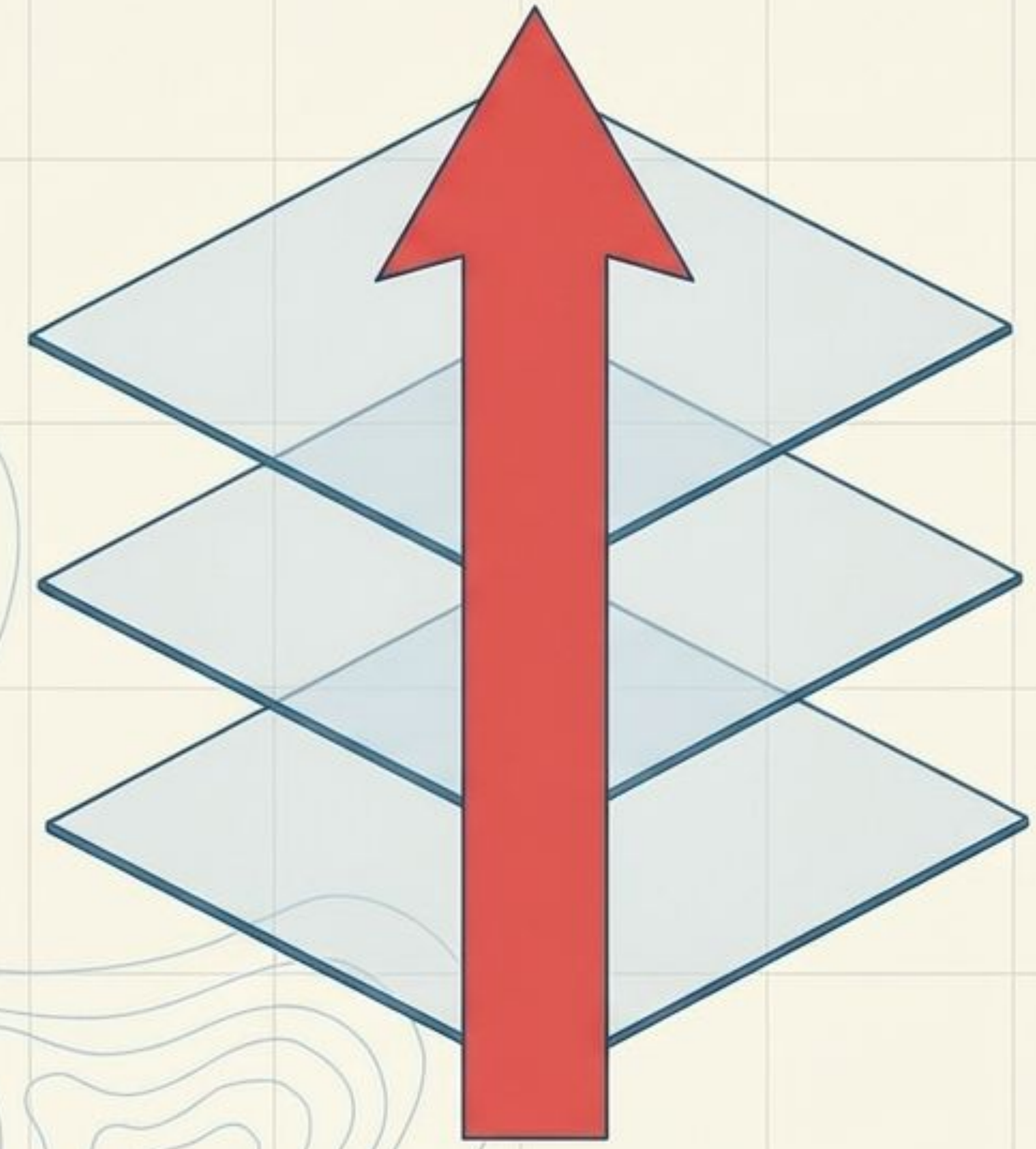
The AI Dividend

Time Saved by AI
(The Efficiency Engine)
Drastically reducing time spent on administrative tasks and draft. Recent research showed that educators who used AI regularly saved an average of 5.9 hours a week.

Time Invested in Connection

The saved time is our AI Dividend. It must be intentionally reinvested back into deepening human connections and relationships with our students.

The Macro-to-Micro Stack

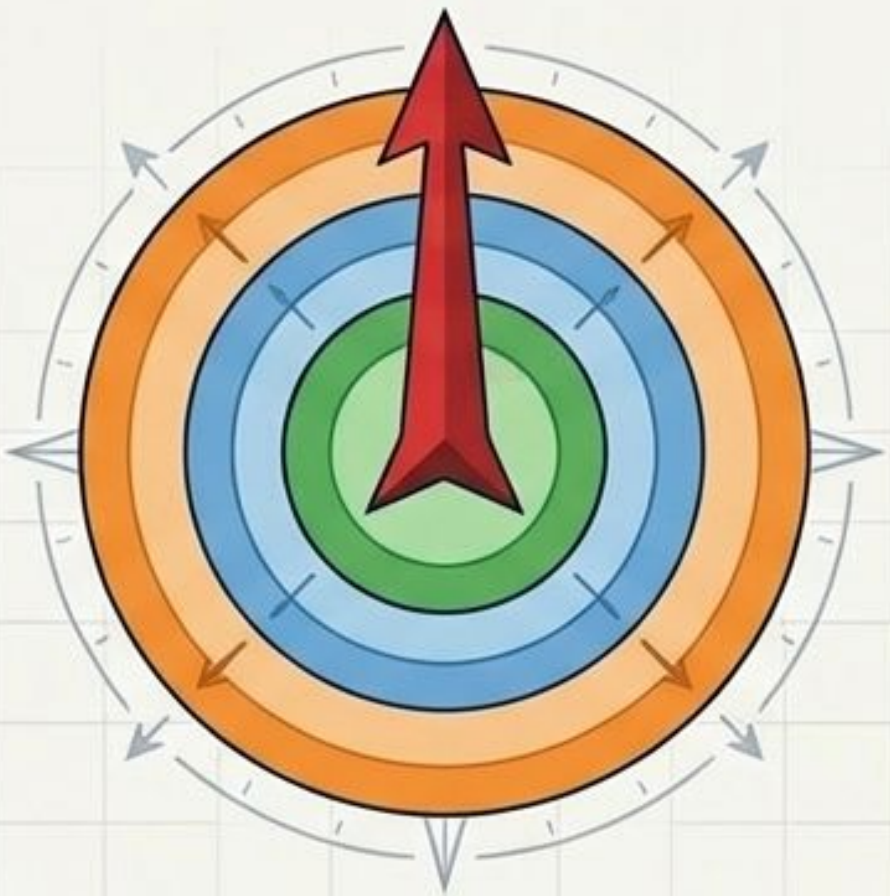


RISE Framework | The Institution.
(Leadership & Governance building the safe container).

AGENCY Framework | The Pedagogy.
(Instructional Design and lesson planning).

PROMPT Framework | The Interaction.
(The tactical interface for human-AI collaboration).

The Navigational Instruments



Outer Ring: RISE (The Institution)

The macro-level governance and foundational structure for a future-ready school.

Middle Ring: AGENCY (The Pedagogy)

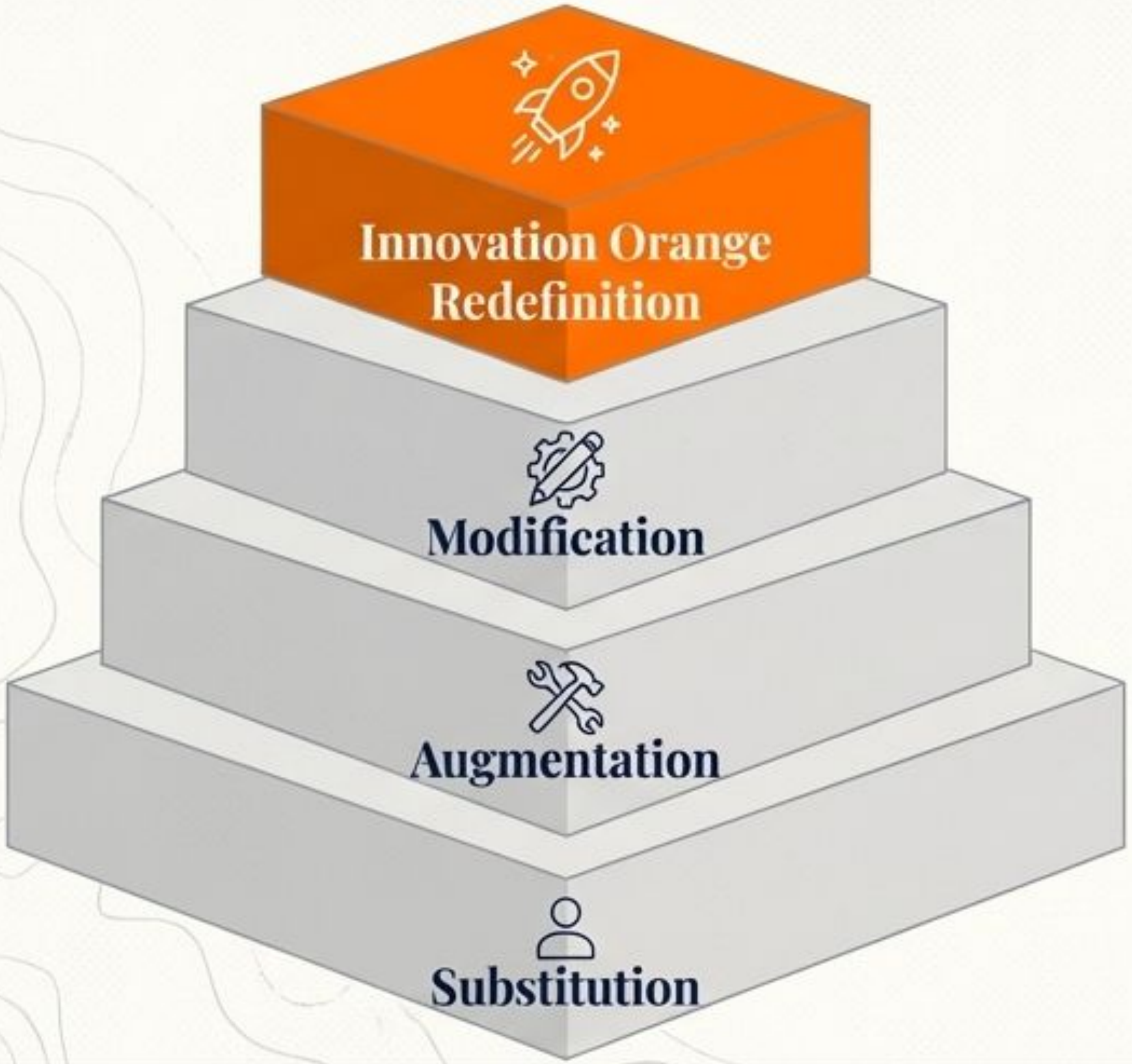
The classroom-level blueprint for educators to design learning experiences that build empowerment and critique.

Center Core: PROMPT (The Interaction)

The micro-level, tactical interface. The steering wheel for daily, structured execution with AI.

Insight Note: You do not need to manage seven different change frameworks. This single "macro-to-micro" stack connects our highest institutional goals to our daily tactical work.

The Era of Agentic AI: Redefining Creation



> **"What if you could code without code?"**

- **Moving Beyond Chatbots:** We are moving from passive tools that simply respond to queries toward proactive partners that can manage entire workflows.
- **Redefinition:** Doing things that were once inconceivable.
- AI is no longer just a calculator or a grammar checker; it is a collaborative engine for bespoke problem-solving.

The Ultimate Affordance: Vibe Coding

What if you could code without code?

Natural Language/Human Intent

Agentic AI/Vibe Coding

The transition from passive consumers to active, agentic creators.
Building functional, personalized AI solutions in minutes using only natural language.
This removes the technical barriers that have held back true constructivism for decades.

Bridging the Gap: The Magic of Vibe Coding

Vibes / Desires

Custom Tool

Human Language as Syntax

Vibe Coding is the translation of human language and intuition directly into functional digital solutions.

Designing for Sustainability

By describing your desired goal to an AI partner, you eiiminate the barrier of complex code.

The Result: True differentiation

You can build internal apps, wellness tools, and personalized learning environments in minutes, exactly tailored to your immediate needs.

Your Turn: The 4-Step Vibe Coding Process

Work alone, with a partner, or in small groups to pave your path.

Step 1: Discovery - The "Why" and the "Who"

Goal: Identify the problem or opportunity that requires a vibe-coded solution.

Action: Clarify your thinking before instructing AI. You cannot delegate what you cannot define. Map out the logic, the rules, and the necessary features.
Ask: What data goes in? What action happens? What is the "Definition of Done"?

Step 2: Deconstruction - Making thinking Visible

Goal: Break the complex challenge down into its core components and underlying requirements.

Action: Before you touch a tool, empathize and observe. Look for friction points in your classroom, department, or workflow. Find a genuine human challenge—a "sticky problem"—that a digital solution could alleviate.

Step 3: Creating the Prompt - The Brief or Art Director's Vision

Goal: Develop a clear, strategic project brief that will guide the creation of your solution.

Action: Use the PROMPT Framework to give clear, ethical instructions to your AI collaborator. You are the Art You are the Art Director; AI is your junior developer. Set parameters, define the persona, and articulate the specific outcome.

Step 4: Creating (in Vibe Coding Studio or Platform) - From Idea to Prototype

Goal: Bring your solution to life by giving your "vibe" to AI and rapidly iterating.

Action: Speak "Human". Use natural language to instruct AI to build the application. If output fails, do not debug code; debug your instructions. Apply Test & Refine to pivot until the prototype matches your vision.

The coming decade will not forgive paralysis. You build your path to AGENCY.

Hands-On: Build Your Path

Call to Action: It's time to build your own bespoke solution.
Work solo, with a partner, or in a small group.

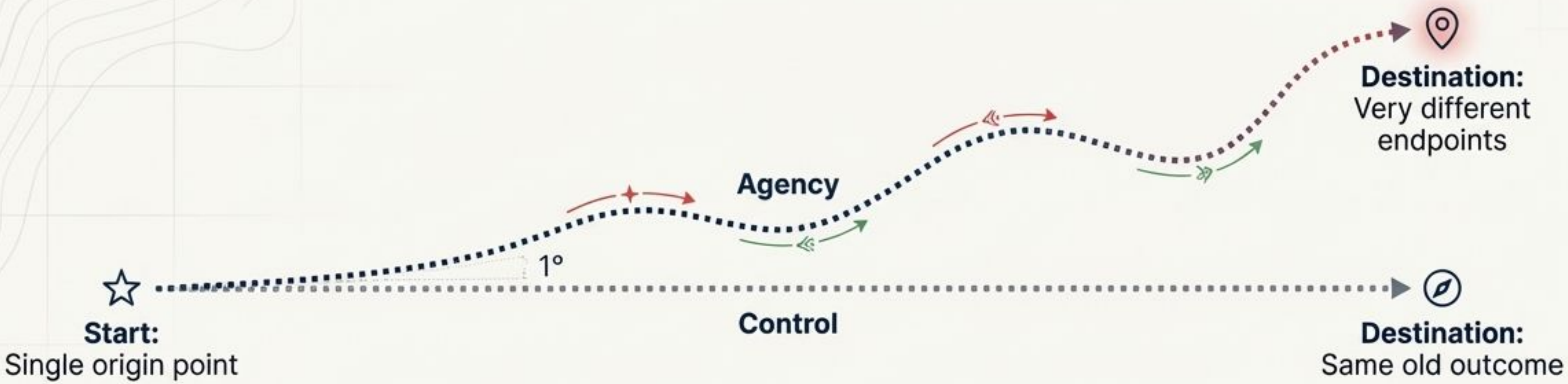
The 4-Step Vibe Coding Process

1. **Define the Purpose:** What specific problem are you solving?
2. **Set the Vibe:** Describe the tone, parameters, and ultimate outcome in plain English.
3. **Collaborate & Prompt:** Input your desires into the AI agent.
4. **Test & Refine:** Iterate on the prototype until it meets your exact standard.

Access the Portal:

truenorthed.tech/#vibecoding

The Tactics: The One-Degree Shift



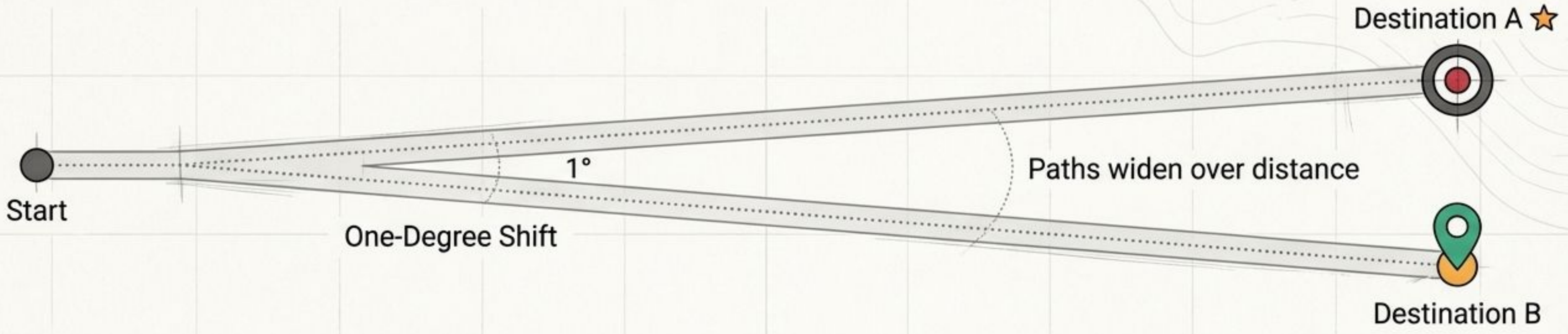
The Concept: Radical transformation often leads to **paralysis**. You do not need to tear up the entire pavement tomorrow.

The Practice: Look for just one Desire Path. Make a 1% change in trajectory.

Example: Keep your traditional final exam, but add a single open-ended question: "Use AI to generate an answer to Question 5. Now, critique the AI's answer. What did it miss?"

The Result: You have stopped protecting the film and started teaching the photographer.

Student Innovation Culture: The One-Degree Shift



You do not need to tear up the entire pavement tomorrow to cultivate a pioneer mindset.

Radical transformation leads to paralysis.

Instead, seek a 1% change in trajectory.

Example: Keep the traditional final exam, but add a single open-ended question: "Use AI to generate an answer to Question 5. Now, critique the AI's answer. What did it miss?"

Stop protecting the film and start teaching the photographer.

Industry Innovates, Education Follows.

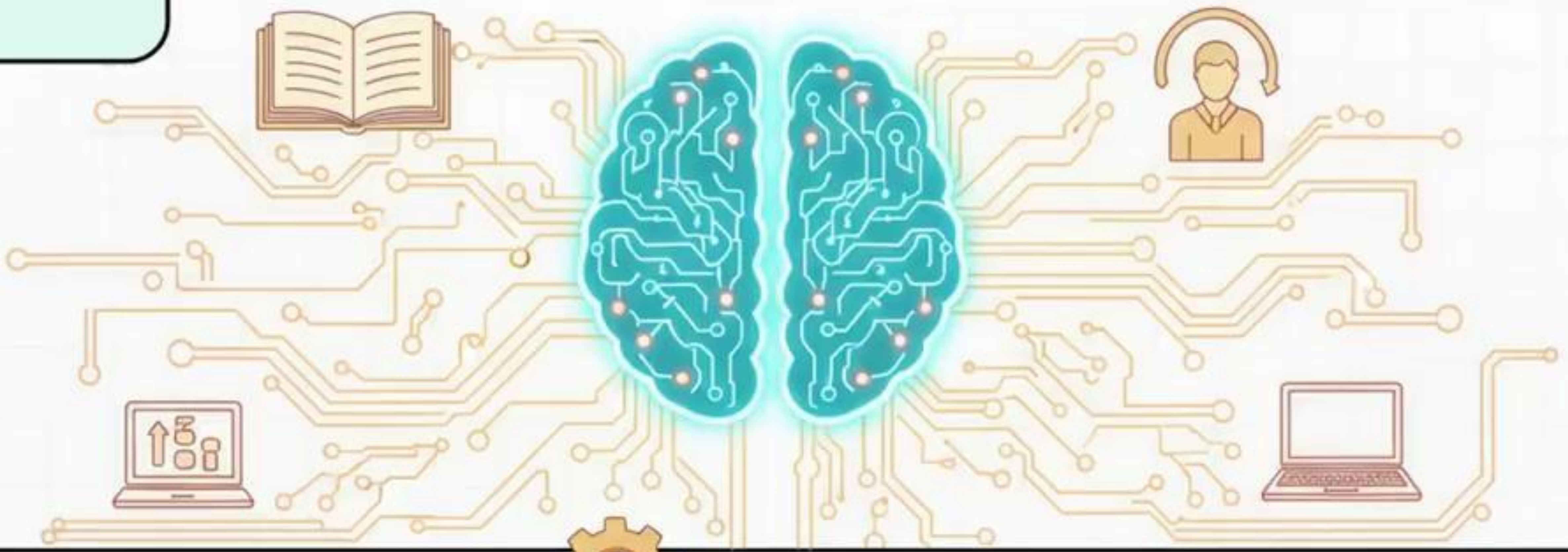
Technology changes rapidly, but the fundamental principles of human learning—growth through meaningful interactions between learner and environment—remain constant. Our challenge is not to reinvent education, but to apply timeless pedagogical wisdom to unprecedented tools.

By designing for AGENCY, we replace the path of fear with the path of growth. We ensure our students learn to command these tools, rather than be commanded by them.

The Courage to Pave the Path

This playbook is for the pioneers ready to choose the path of AGENCY over the path of control. We cannot un-invent the camera. We can only choose whether to build a school that spends its energy repairing fences, or one that spends its energy paving the way.

True North. Human First. Future Ready.



Designing for Agency